Like-for-Like Analysis

SECTION 1

Business Problem

The business is a multi-format Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) retail chain with 21 cities in five regions and Supermarket, Express and Fresh stores. Comparing this year with last year looks simple, but raw calendar comparisons are distorted by the day-of-week mix, month lengths and calendar shifts.

Problem: leadership needs to know whether the business is genuinely growing once these calendar effects are removed, where that growth is strong or weak, and whether it comes from more customers or bigger baskets. Without this, it is hard to decide where to invest, which markets to support and which departments need attention.

Approach and data

Like-for-like (LFL) growth compares equivalent trading days in 2026 against 2025, so day-of-week bias and calendar shifts are removed. The Power BI dashboard covers 151 trading days (1 January to 31 May 2026) across 21 cities, and measures sales growth, transaction growth, average ticket value (ATV) and daily average sales. Values are in Indian rupees (₹); M means million; CY is current year and PY previous year.

+19.33%	+20.90%	−1.30%	21 cities
Like-for-like sales growth	Transaction growth	ATV change (₹694 to ₹685)	151 trading days, Jan to May 2026

SECTION 2

Overall Like-for-Like Growth

Genuine growth of 19.33%, driven by more transactions

- **Sales growth of +19.33%:** strong like-for-like performance across 21 cities and 151 trading days, measured on equivalent days so calendar effects do not distort it.
- **Transaction growth of +20.90%:** higher than sales growth, which points to more customer visits and higher store traffic.
- **Average ticket value down 1.30%:** from ₹694 to ₹685, so customers are spending slightly less per trip.

What this means

- **Healthy, volume-driven growth:** more customers are visiting stores, but they spend marginally less per visit.
- **Possible reasons (to be validated):** a shift toward smaller baskets, or promotional activity that drives traffic.
- **Opportunity:** raising basket size through trading-up offers would amplify the volume growth already in place.
- **Sustainable driver:** growth through customer count is a durable source of growth, and the ATV decline is modest compared with the traffic gain, though it needs watching.

> **So what**
> The 19% growth is genuine business improvement, not a calendar effect, and it is strong performance for retail.

SECTION 3

Regional Performance

All regions grow at double digits; West leads and Central trails

- **West: +21.68% sales growth**, the leading region, with 4 cities and transactions +23.0%.
- **South:** +19.90% sales growth, in second place, with transactions +22.0%.
- **North:** +19.42% sales growth, close behind, with 5 cities (the most of any region).
- **East:** +18.50% sales growth, solid growth with 4 cities.
- **Central: +16.24% sales growth**, the lowest but still double-digit, with 4 cities.

SECTION 4

City Performance: Leaders and Laggards

Top 10 cities: growth of 19.7% to 27.1%

- **Nagpur (West), +27.13%:** the leading city, with ₹8.6M of sales, transactions +27.1% and the Fresh format.
- **Noida (North), +26.14%:** ₹23.1M of sales, Supermarket format.
- **Indore (Central), +25.90%:** ₹9.3M of sales, transactions +24.7%, Fresh format.
- **Bangalore (South), +25.51%:** the largest sales at ₹24.0M, transactions +29.7%, Supermarket format.
- **Coimbatore (South), +23.32%:** ₹8.7M of sales, transactions +22.7%, Fresh format.
- **Pune (West), +22.92%:** ₹23.4M of sales, transactions +26.5%, Supermarket format.
- **Kolkata (East), +21.16%:** ₹23.6M of sales, transactions +26.3%, Supermarket format.
- **Bhubaneswar (East), +21.01%:** ₹7.8M of sales, transactions +22.0%, Fresh format.
- **Surat (West), +20.60%:** ₹21.0M of sales, transactions +21.8%, Supermarket format.
- **Lucknow (North), +19.71%:** ₹8.3M of sales, transactions +20.7%, Express format.

Bottom 10 cities: growth of 9.2% to 16.9%

- **Chandigarh (North), +16.91%:** ₹21.5M of sales, transactions +19.6%, Supermarket format.
- **Patna (East), +16.54%:** ₹7.4M of sales, transactions +17.8%, Express format.
- **Bhopal (Central), +15.29%:** ₹18.9M of sales, transactions +20.1%, Supermarket format.
- **Guwahati (East), +15.02%:** ₹18.4M of sales, transactions +16.2%, Supermarket format.
- **Nashik (West), +15.00%:** ₹7.1M of sales, transactions +15.2%, Express format.
- **Mysore (South), +14.51%:** ₹7.5M of sales, transactions +16.8%, Express format.
- **Kochi (South), +14.20%:** ₹19.3M of sales, transactions +16.8%, Supermarket format.
- **Raipur (Central), +13.88%:** ₹7.1M of sales, transactions +13.9%, Express format.
- **Dehradun (North), +12.65%:** ₹7.2M of sales, transactions +13.4%, Express format.
- **Jabalpur (Central), +9.24%:** the lowest growth, with ₹6.4M of sales, transactions +9.5% and the Express format.

Format patterns

- **Top 10:** 5 Supermarket, 4 Fresh and 1 Express city.
- **Bottom 10:** 6 Express and 4 Supermarket cities, and no Fresh city.
- **Fresh stands out:** Nagpur, Indore, Coimbatore and Bhubaneswar are all in the top 10, and no Fresh city is in the bottom 10.
- **Express is the weak format:** it is consistently in the bottom tier, which raises the question of whether smaller stores need a different model. Lucknow is the exception.

Geographic patterns

- **West dominates the top 10** with 3 cities (Nagpur, Pune, Surat).
- **Central struggles:** 3 of its 4 cities (Bhopal, Raipur, Jabalpur) are in the bottom 10.
- **North is polarised:** Noida and Lucknow perform strongly, while Chandigarh and Dehradun are in the bottom 10.
- **All cities are growing:** even the weakest city, Jabalpur, grew 9%.

SECTION 5

Department Performance

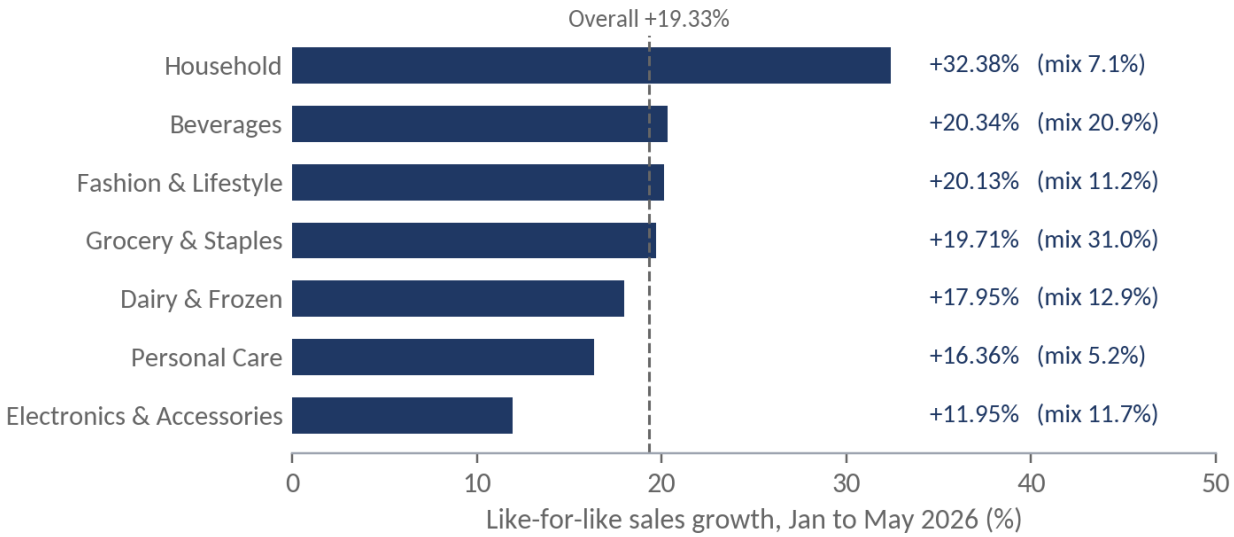


Figure 1: Like-for-like sales growth by department, with share of sales (mix), January to May 2026

Household leads, Electronics lags

- **Household, +32.38%:** the breakout performer, with ₹21.3M of sales (7.1% mix) and transactions +33.9%.
- **Beverages, +20.34%:** ₹62.6M of sales (20.9% mix), transactions +28.4%.
- **Fashion & Lifestyle, +20.13%:** ₹33.4M of sales (11.2% mix), transactions +25.9% and a high ATV of ₹1,385.
- **Grocery & Staples, +19.71%:** the largest department at ₹92.7M (31.0% mix), transactions +24.8%.
- **Dairy & Frozen, +17.95%:** ₹38.5M of sales (12.9% mix) and transactions +33.9%.
- **Personal Care, +16.36%:** ₹15.5M of sales (5.2% mix), transactions +18.2%.
- **Electronics & Accessories, +11.95%:** the weakest growth, with ₹34.9M of sales (11.7% mix), transactions +17.1% and the highest ATV at ₹1,846.

Transactions outgrow sales in every department

- **Highest visit growth:** Dairy & Frozen and Household both show transactions +33.9%.
- **Beverages:** transactions (+28.4%) grow much faster than sales (+20.3%), which means more frequent, smaller purchases.
- **Dairy & Frozen:** transactions +34% against sales only +18%, which suggests a shift to lower-priced items or promotions (to be validated).
- **Electronics:** transactions (+17.1%) also exceed sales (+12.0%), which means a lower average ticket.
- **Volume-led, with price dilution:** the dashboard shows quantity growth above sales growth in every department (Household +41.0%, Dairy & Frozen +35.5%, Grocery +35.1%), while average selling price is lower than last year in every department (from −3.3% in Electronics to −12.9% in Dairy & Frozen).

Grocery & Staples drill-down

- **Fastest growers:** Sugar & Salt (+44.0%, ₹4.12M) and Flour & Atta (+35.5%, ₹17.13M).
- **Steady:** Pulses & Lentils (+22.1%, ₹8.64M) and Cooking Oil & Ghee (+20.0%, ₹19.20M).
- **Largest but slower:** Rice & Grains is the biggest category at ₹32.92M but grew only +13.7%, with average selling price −11.4% and ATV −7.5%.
- **Weakest:** Dry Fruits & Nuts (+5.0%, ₹6.37M), followed by Spices & Masalas (+12.1%, ₹4.28M).

So what
Household's 32% growth deserves investigation: a new launch, an effective promotion or category repositioning. Customers are visiting more often and buying less per trip across most departments, consistent with the overall −1.3% ATV decline. This could reflect a move toward convenience over stock-up shopping, or promotions driving traffic.

SECTION 6

Monthly Trading Patterns

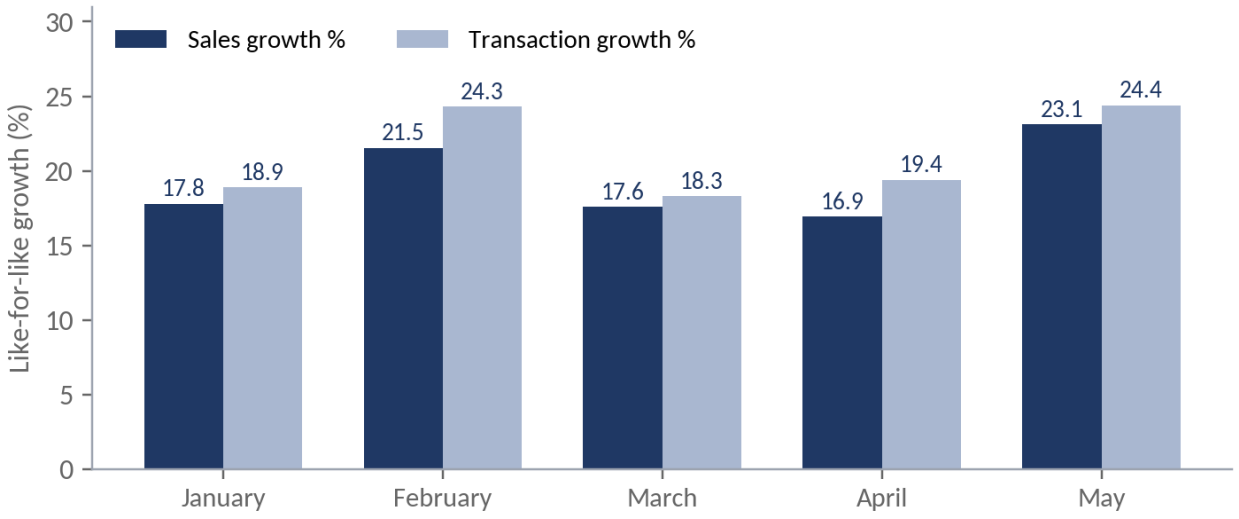


Figure 2: Like-for-like sales growth and transaction growth by month, 2026 (overall: sales +19.33%, transactions +20.90%)

Month-by-month results (151 trading days)

- **January 2026:** sales ₹60.6M (+17.80%) over 31 trading days, 88.6K transactions (+18.9%). Daily sales ₹1.95M against ₹1.66M. ATV ₹684 against ₹690 (−0.9%).
- **February 2026:** sales ₹55.3M (+21.54%) over 28 trading days, 80.3K transactions (+24.3%). Daily sales ₹1.97M against ₹1.62M. ATV ₹689 against ₹704 (−2.2%).
- **March 2026:** sales ₹64.4M (+17.58%) over 31 trading days, 94.2K transactions (+18.3%), the highest volume. Daily sales ₹2.08M against ₹1.77M. ATV ₹683 against ₹687 (−0.6%), the best retention.
- **April 2026:** sales ₹57.0M (+16.95%) over 30 trading days, 83.9K transactions (+19.4%). Daily sales ₹1.90M against ₹1.62M. ATV ₹679 against ₹693 (−2.0%).
- **May 2026:** sales ₹61.6M (+23.12%) over 31 trading days, 89.2K transactions (+24.4%). Daily sales ₹1.99M against ₹1.61M. ATV ₹690 against ₹697 (−1.0%).

Growth pattern

- **Strongest and softest months:** May is the strongest (+23.12%) and April the softest (+16.95%). Q1 (January to March) ranged from 17.6% to 21.5% and averaged about 19%.
- **Narrow spread:** the gap between the best and weakest month is 6.1 points, which indicates stable underlying performance. Growth moves up and down from month to month rather than climbing steadily.
- **Transactions outgrow sales every month:** by about 1.6 points overall, with transaction growth of 18% to 24% against sales growth of 17% to 23%. February (+24.3%) and May (+24.4%) stand out.
- **ATV falls in every month:** by 0.6% to 2.2%, with March showing the best retention.

SECTION 7

Summary

- **Overall:** like-for-like sales are up 19.33%, driven by transaction growth of 20.90%, while ATV is down 1.30% (₹694 to ₹685).
- **Regions:** West leads (+21.68%) and Central trails (+16.24%). Every region grows at double digits, and the spread is only about 5 points.
- **Cities:** Nagpur (+27.13%) and Noida (+26.14%) lead, Jabalpur (+9.24%) trails, and every city is growing. Fresh and Supermarket cities outperform Express, which accounts for 6 of the 10 weakest cities.
- **Departments:** Household (+32.38%) is the breakout performer, core categories grow steadily at 18% to 20%, and Electronics (+11.95%) lags.
- **Price and volume:** transactions outgrow sales in every department, quantity outgrows sales, and average selling price is lower than last year across all departments.
- **Months:** growth ranges from 17.0% (April) to 23.1% (May), with March the strongest day-for-day month.

SECTION 8

Recommendations

1. **Raise basket size.** Use bundles, upsell and trading-up offers to reverse the 1.30% ATV decline, starting where average selling price fell most: Dairy & Frozen, Grocery & Staples (especially Rice & Grains) and Beverages.
2. **Study and replicate the winners.** Review what works in the West region, in Nagpur (+27.13%) and Noida (+26.14%), in Household (+32.38%), and in Flour & Atta and Sugar & Salt.
3. **Investigate the Central region.** Three of its four cities are in the bottom 10, and Jabalpur grew only 9.24%. Find out whether the cause is market maturity, competition or operations.
4. **Review the Express format.** It makes up 6 of the 10 weakest cities. Examine assortment, pricing and store viability, and learn from Lucknow, the Express city in the top 10.
5. **Diagnose Electronics.** Growth of only +11.95% on the highest ticket needs a review of assortment, pricing and competition.
6. **Build on the Fresh format.** It appears in 4 of the top 10 cities and none of the bottom 10, so consider extending it where Express underperforms.
7. **Learn from March and plan around April.** Analyse March's promotions and assortment, prepare an April plan for the softer month, and track whether May's momentum holds through the second half.

Sales values are on a like-for-like basis and are lower than total sales. Department and category quantity, price and ATV details come from the Like-for-Like dashboard.